Section 1 - Problem, Stakeholders and Competitors

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Problem

When you move into a rental in NSW you have to fill in a condition report and send it back to the agent, usually within a week. At the end of the lease, if the landlord claims part of your bond for damage, the only way to argue it is to show the damage was already there when you moved in. If it goes to NCAT, the tenant has to back up their side with evidence (NSW Government, n.d.).

In practice most renters just take a few photos on their phone and fill in the form by hand. A year later those photos are buried in the camera roll, not sorted by room, and the dates can be lost if they were sent over messaging apps. So when the bond is claimed, the tenant often has nothing solid to show.

Who it's for

The target user is a first-time or student renter in Sydney, renting through an agent, often with housemates. Their bond is four weeks' rent, which is a lot of money for them. They're comfortable with an iPhone but don't know what kind of evidence would actually hold up in a dispute.

Evidence

- 31% of Australian households rented at the 2021 Census, about 2.9 million households (AIHW, 2025). In NSW the number of renting households grew by over 17.5% between 2016 and 2021 (Mowbray, 2022).
- A Finder survey of 2,003 Australians found over 30% of people who had rented and moved in the last five years lost some or all of their bond, with damage the most common reason (Whitten, 2018).

Competitors

	Resident Inventory	**zTenant**	**MoveIn Proof**
Who can use it	Tenants whose agency uses it	Tenants invited by their property manager	Any tenant
Account	Login required	Invite and login required	None
Data	Report sent to the property manager; collects user and device IDs	Collects location, name and email	Stays on the phone, nothing collected
Timestamp on photo	Not mentioned	Not mentioned	Burned into every photo

Both apps are free and do the basics well (photos by room, a report at the end), but they're built for property managers. The tenant can't just download one and use it, and the report goes to the agency. The other option, the Camera app plus the paper form, has no structure at all.

MoveIn Proof is aimed at the tenant. There's no account, nothing leaves the phone, every photo has the date and time stamped on it, and the tenant gets their own PDF report. The widget also keeps the report due date on the Home Screen.

Why iOS

The main job is taking photos in each room, so it needs to be a phone app. It works offline (new rentals often don't have internet yet) because everything is stored on the device with SwiftData, and the photos are protected by iOS file encryption. WidgetKit shows the key dates on the Home Screen, and the share sheet makes it easy to send the PDF to the agent.

References

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